



The Humanitas Institute

# Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Fortis Academy  
School Website: <https://fortisacademy.net/>

December 21, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Fortis Academy (Liberty Hill, Texas; 78642) presents a robust Classical Christian program anchored in a Trivium pedagogy, strong Great Books orientation, and a University-Model school structure that emphasizes active parental partnership. Public materials from the Fortis site consistently frame the school as Christ-centered, biblically informed, and committed to forming character (truth, goodness, beauty) alongside intellect. Across multiple sections (School of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, admissions, and parent partnership pages) Fortis foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and a public-facing claim of "great conversation" with classical texts. The school also emphasizes a collaborative university-model (teacher + parent co-teaching) and a defined structure for grades K–12 that integrates at-home mentorship with on-campus instruction. On balance, the Fortis materials align strongly with the six elements of classical education.

Overall ranking by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Fortis presents a Christ-centered, biblically informed worldview and explicit theological framing (e.g., "Christ-Centered Classical Education," "biblical worldview," and references to God's truth, beauty, and goodness). Public statements emphasize theology and biblical formation as core to education.  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords identified include Christ-centered, biblical worldview, theology, truth, beauty, goodness, God, Bible. No explicit negative signals observed in the public materials related to religious foundations. Positives clearly outweigh negatives. Why this rating: The materials consistently ground education in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian frame, aligning with the Positive Keywords for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Mission statement and programmatic aims emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, human flourishing, and participation in the Great Conversation. Fortis describes formation through classical education and its aim to cultivate virtuous thinkers prepared to lead for the glory of God.  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, great conversation, telos, classical mission. Negative keywords (workforce- or job-prep focus) are not foregrounded in public materials. Positives dominate. Why this rating: Fortis champions formation and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful ends over narrow vocational metrics, aligning with CLASSICAL.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Curriculum sections emphasize the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and classical languages, Great Books, history-based integration, and integration with theology. Public materials explicitly note Great Books, Latin, and a unified liberal-arts-containing curriculum under the Trivium framework.  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include grammar, logic, rhetoric, liberal arts, Great Books, primary sources, classical languages, history, and Latin. Negative signals such as "social

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studies” terminology replacing history or STEM-first framing are not used to frame the Fortis curriculum in the public materials. Predominantly positive signals. Why this rating: The explicit emphasis on the Trivium, Great Books, and a liberal-arts curriculum places Fortis squarely in CLASSICAL territory.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence: Pedagogical methods include Socratic discussion (Rhetoric/Logic stages), memory work (recitation, singing, and chanted memory), and “formation through imitation and practice.” Fortis also documents cognitive discipline through discourse and a restive, contemplative pace for aspects of learning (Scholé-like elements) in its public descriptions. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, great conversation, memorization/recitation, chanting, restfulness (Scholé), and imitation of models. No obvious negative pedagogical signals in the public content. Strong positive alignment. Why this rating: Fortis consistently describes a pedagogy that blends Socratic discussion with memory work and imitation—a hallmark of classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Fortis presents its faculty as distinguished, virtuous, and the living curriculum; the school emphasizes teachers as mentors and living exemplars with a collaborative, collegial culture. Public materials highlight the faculty’s role as central to the learning experience and the school’s ethos. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtuous educators, living curriculum, master-teacher model, mentorship, collegial culture. Negative keywords (as signals of non-classical faculty models) are not evident in the Fortis materials. Why this rating: The public content frames faculty as exemplars and mentors in a classical framework.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Fortis emphasizes a collaborative university-model with strong parent involvement (parents as co-teachers, home-based engagement, and quarterly training). The school describes parent partnership, open access for parents, and shared mission with families. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, parent formation, home-school integration, open campus, and parental involvement. Negative signals are not present in public materials; Fortis frames parents as central to the educational project. Why this rating: The Fortis model explicitly centers parental involvement and partnership in the classical framework, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL based on keyword presence in Fortis Academy’s public materials and the alignment with the Six Essential Elements’ positive indicators.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable (Fortis is CLASSICAL across all six categories). No needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully classical designation.

Note on method - The analysis uses a keyword framework anchored in the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document, which provides explicit Positive Keywords (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; scholé; memory work; imitation; partnership with families) and Negative Keywords (e.g., relativism; secular ethics; project-based learning dominance; lack of great books; lack of theology). Fortis materials consistently map to these positive indicators, particularly in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parents & Community. See the Classical Elements lexicon and the Six Essential Elements documentation for indicator lists and definitions.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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